

Microsoft Kinect

This is the name given to Project Natal, Microsoft's motion sensor controller for their X-Box 360 console. It is expected to hit markets later this year

MS downs Stereo 3D

Microsoft doesn't believe that Stereo 3D is going to make a huge splash soon, and have announced they have no plans to devote resources to 3D in the X-Box 360



INQ Chat 3G

Mini communicator!

The Chat 3G is a nicely built phone, although quality of materials used isn't outstanding, the phone is put together nicely. It's chic too – the front is glossy black, the QWERTY keypad is identical in design to Nokia's E72/E71/E63, although the menu but-

tons have a different layout. The side features a chrome trim running right around. The volume rocker is on the left, and one press will only move the volume by a single gradation – ergonomic blunder. The single button on the right cycles through the row of widgets on the bottom of the screen. The phone is slow, many times, even switching to the main menu has a two-second lag.

The selling point is the social networking angle, with a pretty usable full keypad and support for Twitter, Facebook and Orkut, the Chat 3G is pretty decent in this regard, although we're yet to see the full deployment of the 3G spectrum here.

One neat addition is the music syncing, the bundled software will sync even from iTunes, and just drag and drop – non compatible formats are converted, although some formats like FLAC are not recognisable. Call clarity is good, although we dropped a call in zone three, voice quality was good, but not as good as some Nokia and Blackberry handsets, loud-speaker volume in-call is poor.

Priced at Rs. 7,599, the INQ Chat 3G is a good device for those looking for something that's easy to chat and network with. People looking for the status associated with bigger brands or drool value will not be interested.

Contact

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Web site: www.inq-mobile.com
Price: Rs. 7,599

7/10

Features.....	6.5
Performance.....	7
Build.....	7
Value.....	8

NBOX N32 HD Media Player

Media player par ordinaire

Requirements:

Pentium CPU or higher, 128 MB, 35 MB disk space, Windows 7 / Vista / XP / 2003

Contact

Contact: Trans Innovators
Phone: 9324421353
Email: syngwind@sify.com
Web site: NA
Price: Rs. 2,000

6/10

Features.....	5.5
Performance.....	3.5
Build.....	5.5
Value.....	8

The N32 is a compact media player that boasts high definition out of the box. Build quality is very mediocre – built to a budget with cheap quality plastics and the buttons on the top are a little hard. The display on the front just has a basic power LED embedded in it. A USB port sits on the right, with an SD card slot on the left. Connectivity is via a single Component connect while an RCA connect handles audio. The remote unit is tiny but cute. The menu system is very simple, and the options very basic. Hardly any settings are configurable, not that this is bad, since this player is aimed at those wanting a simple,

uncomplicated device.

There was noticeable graininess and noise in VOB files, along with some tonal noise and pixilation in moving parts of a scene. Colours aren't accurate, and at times appear slightly faded. There is slight lag with the memory system. Support up to 720p but MKV and other uncompressed formats are not supported. There is also a problem with playing non-standard resolution MP4 files. DivX and AVI files play properly, but with the problems listed above – but there is no skipping. However, when playing 720p content, we noticed quite a bit of skipping –



in fact the movie was unwatchable, and the audio also skips at times – overall poor performance. Uncompressed audio formats aren't supported. The price is killer – at Rs. 2,000 the NBOX N32 is cheaper than DVD players, and it will handle everything a DVD player can do and then some, the only issue is the quality that is mediocre at best.